

Notes on the Fretboard

Standard View—Low E String on Bottom

Musical Alphabet

The musical alphabet goes from A–G and repeats over and over.

A B C D E F G A B C D E F G

White Keys

If we look at this on a piano, these notes (A, B, C, D, E, F, G) are on the white keys.

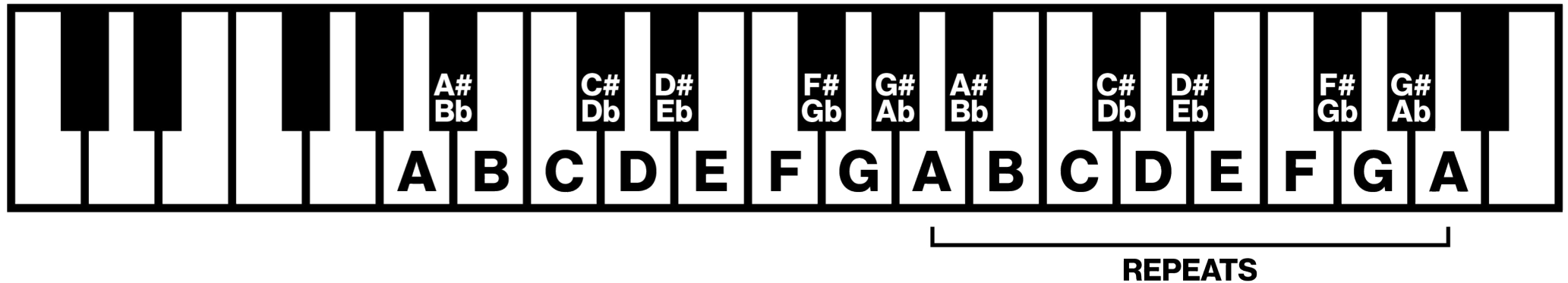


Black Keys

On the black keys, you have sharps (#) and flats (b).

Sharp = up one note

Flat = down one note



Once you get back to “A” again, the pattern repeats.

Sharps & Flats

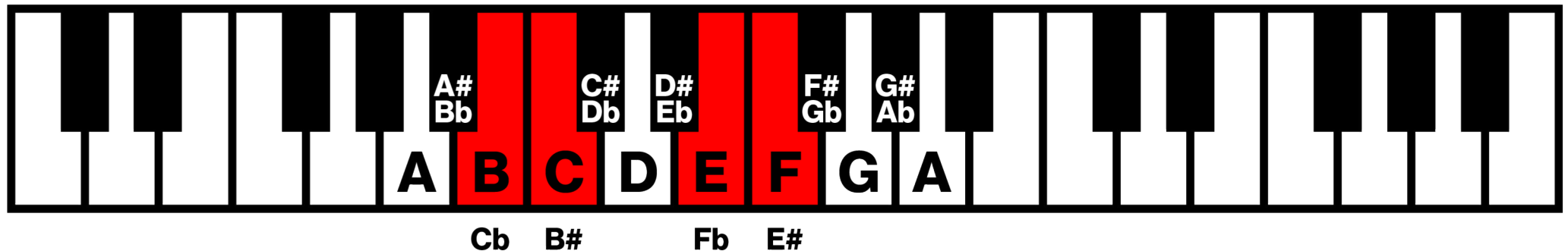
Depending on what key/scale you're in, sometimes you'll call these notes by a different name:

B = C $\flat$

C = B $\sharp$

E = F $\flat$

F = E $\sharp$



You also have double sharps, double flats, etc.

But let's not drink from a firehose and bang our heads against the wall :)

For now, let's keep it simple and refer to these as B, C, E and F.

Once you get the basics down, you can go a little deeper into music theory.

All Notes

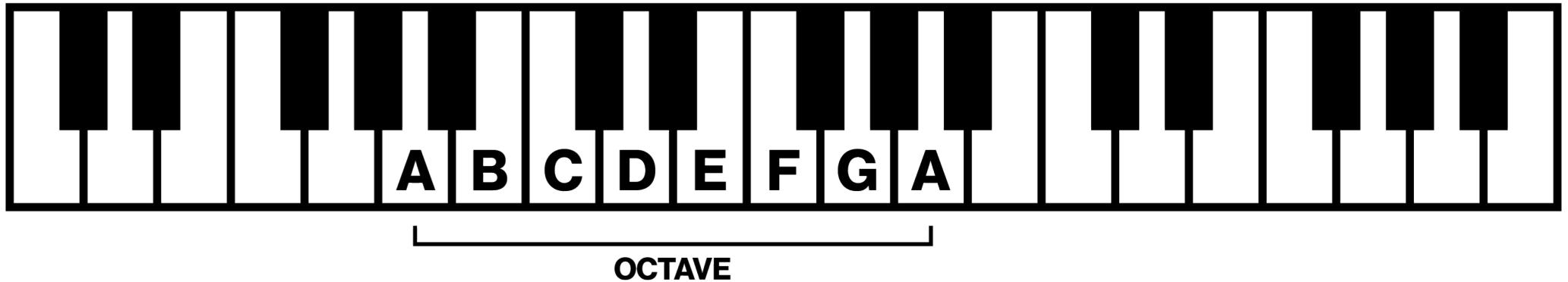
Including all the white & black keys, you have a total of 12 notes that repeat over and over.

1. A
2. A#/Bb
3. B
4. C
5. C#/Db
6. D
7. D#/Eb
8. E
9. F
10. F#/Gb
11. G
12. G#/Ab

Octave

An octave is two notes that are 8 notes apart from each other (if you're using a major or minor scale).
Oct = 8

These two notes have the same letter name.
So the distance between “A” and “A” is an octave.



*Note: If you're using the chromatic scale (ALL notes–white and black keys), it would be 12 notes apart.

Guitar Section

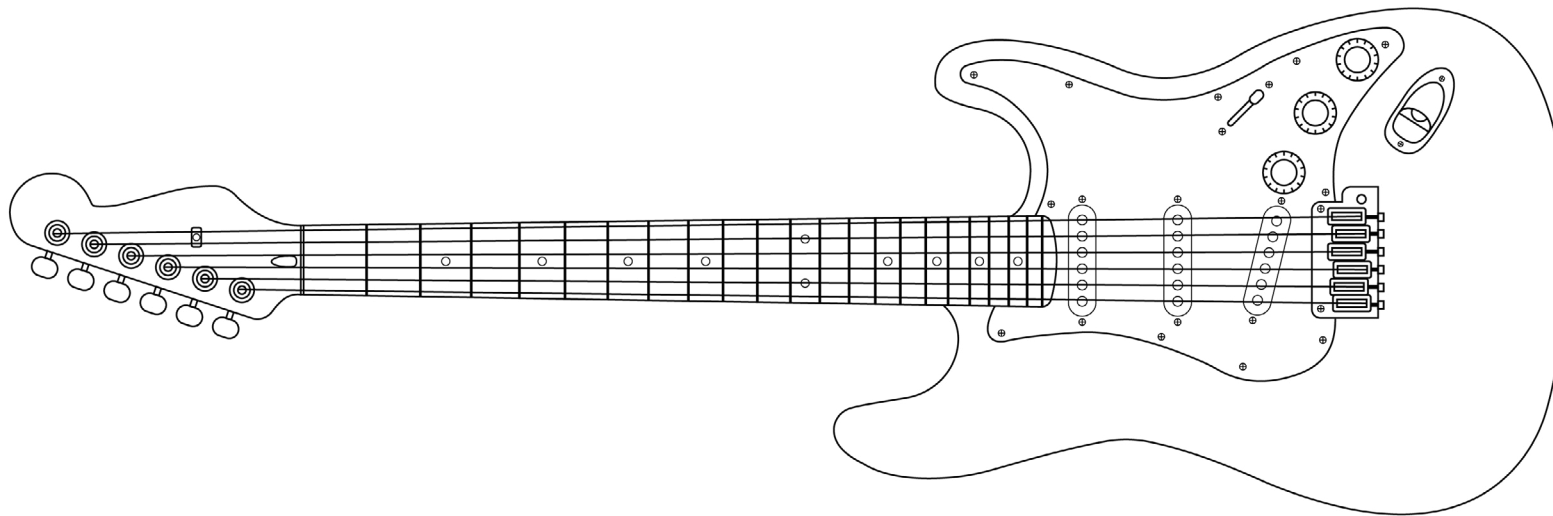
In this section, we'll look at the guitar in standard view.

The low E string (thickest) is on the bottom, headstock on the left.

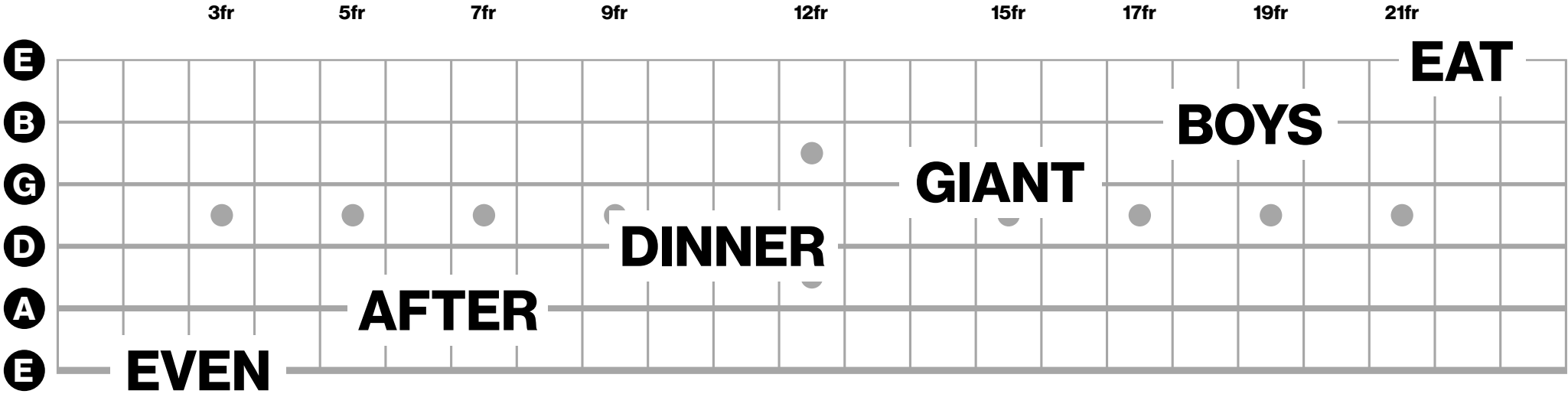
It might feel backwards at first, but here's what helped me:

Imagine the guitar flat in your lap with the headstock pointing to the left.

Looking down, the low E string is on the bottom—same as guitar tabs and most fretboard diagrams.



Names of the Strings



Notes on the 'E' String (no sharps/flats)

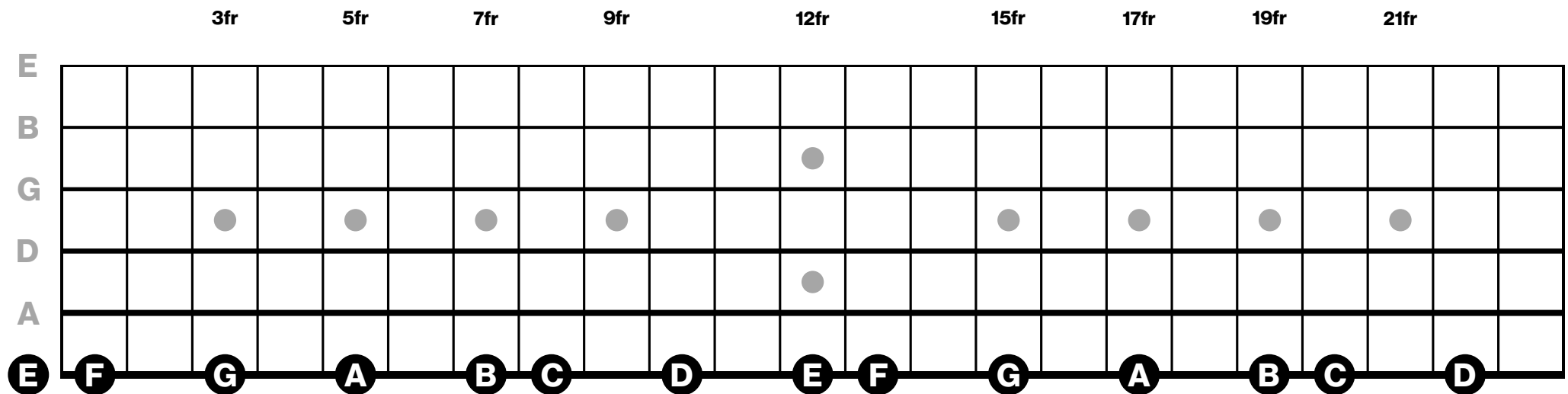
Let's start with the low E string.

We're going to do these without the sharps and flats for now, but we'll get to those in a second.

Start with the E string open, and go up the musical alphabet from there:

E, F, G, A, B, C, D

Starting on the 12th fret, the pattern repeats.

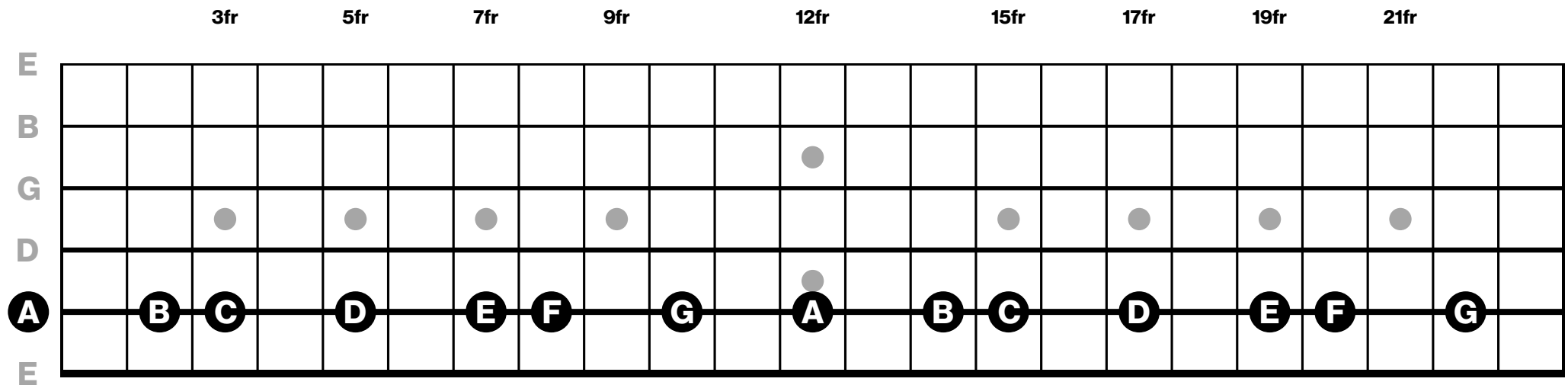


Notes on the 'A' String (no sharps/flats)

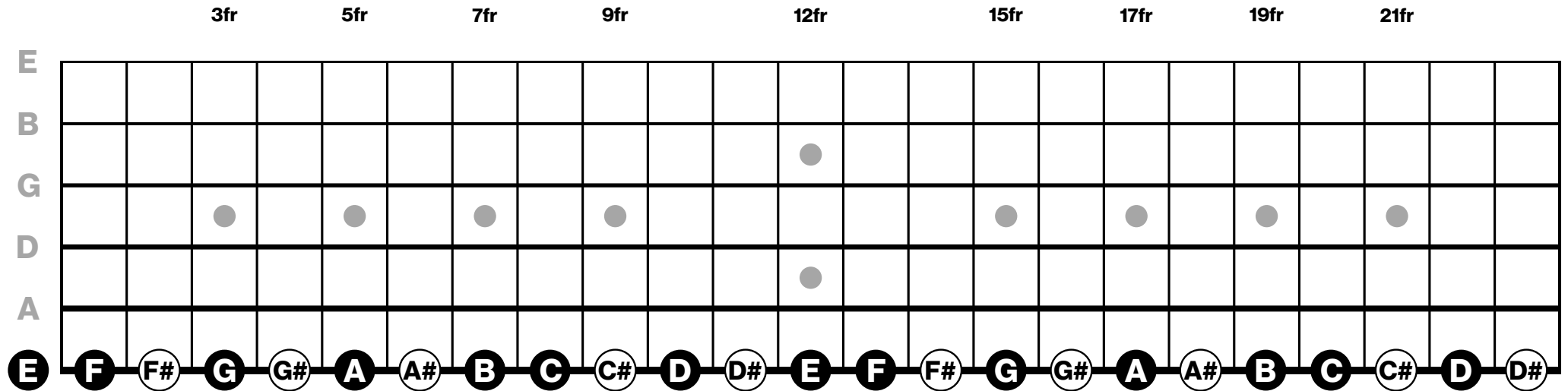
Now, let's do the A string with no sharps or flats.

A, B, C, D, E, F, G

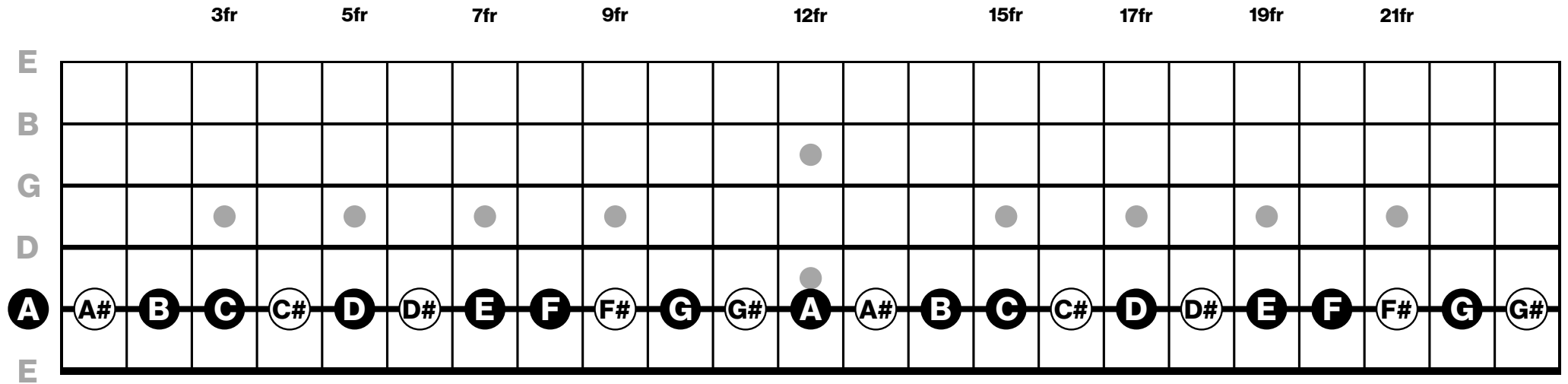
Starting on the 12th fret, the pattern repeats.



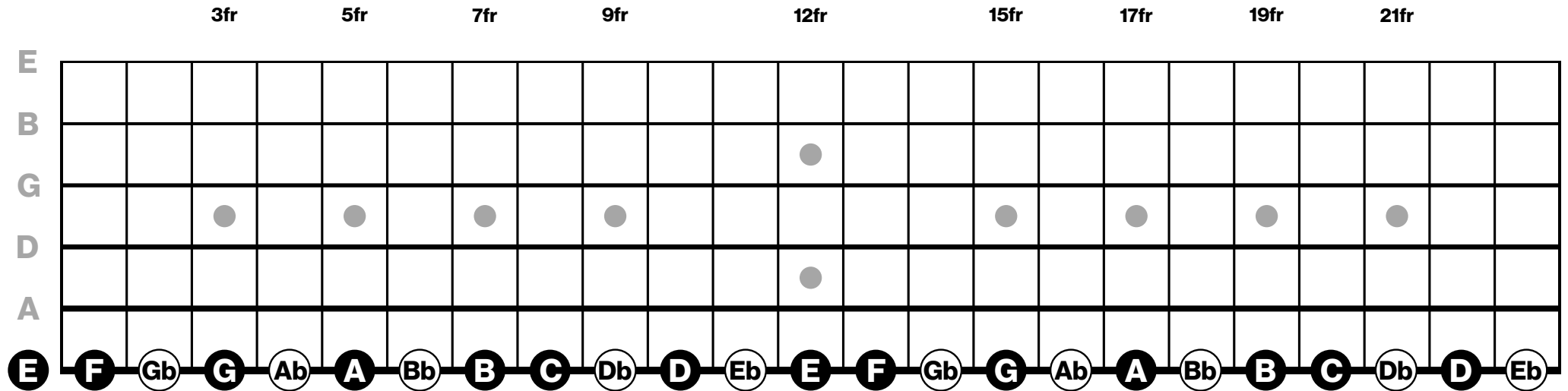
Notes on the 'E' String (with sharps)



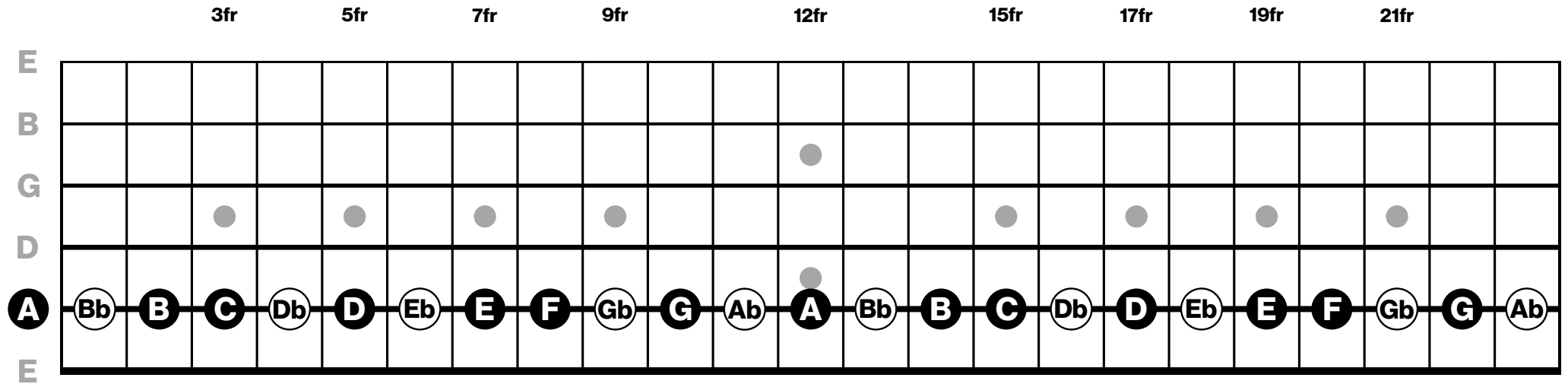
Notes on the 'A' String (with sharps)



Notes on the 'E' String (with flats)



Notes on the 'A' String (with flats)



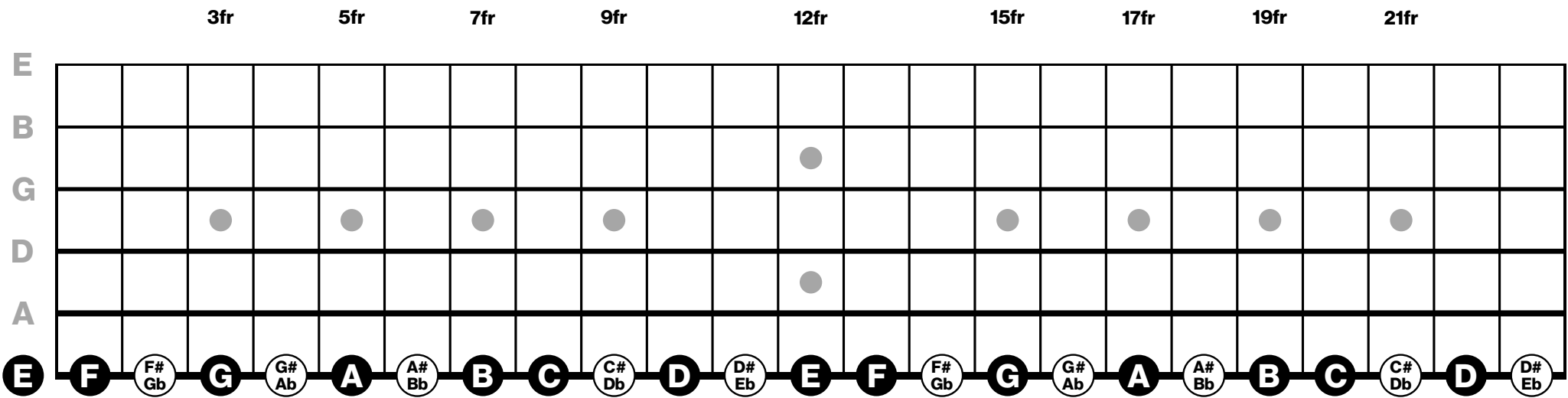
Sharps and Flats

Now, we're going to put all that together and do the sharps AND flats.

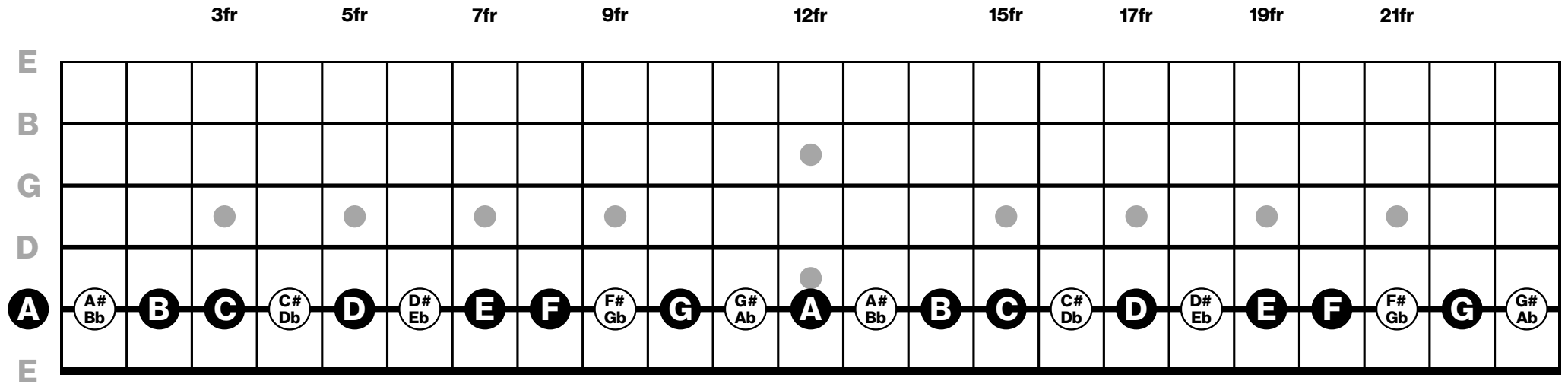
Using our octave trick (which we're about to get to), you only need to start with memorizing the notes on the low E string and A string.

But I'm going to throw in diagrams for each string for your reference, along with a diagram of the ENTIRE fretboard (with sharps and flats).

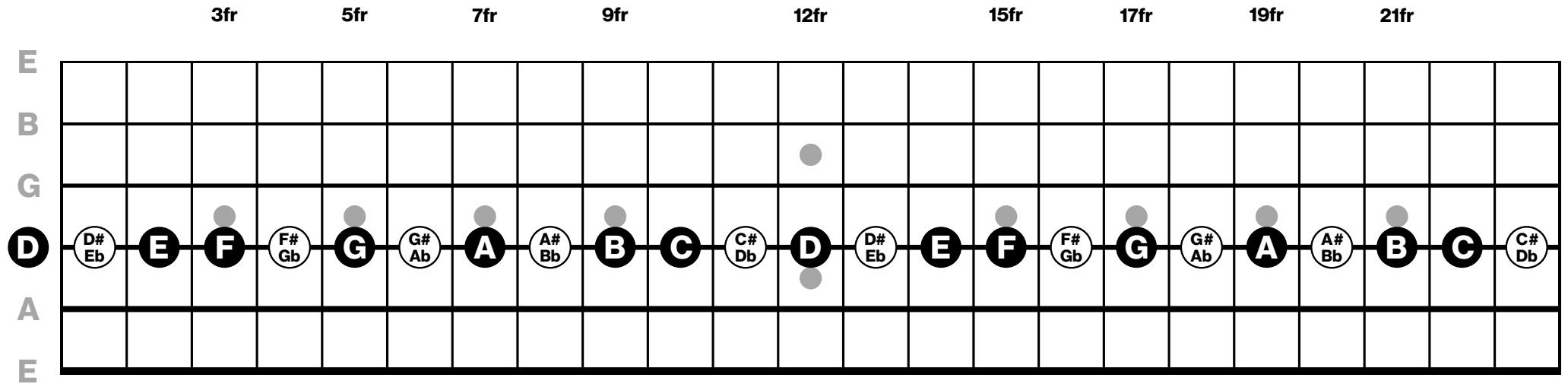
Notes on the 'E' String (Low)



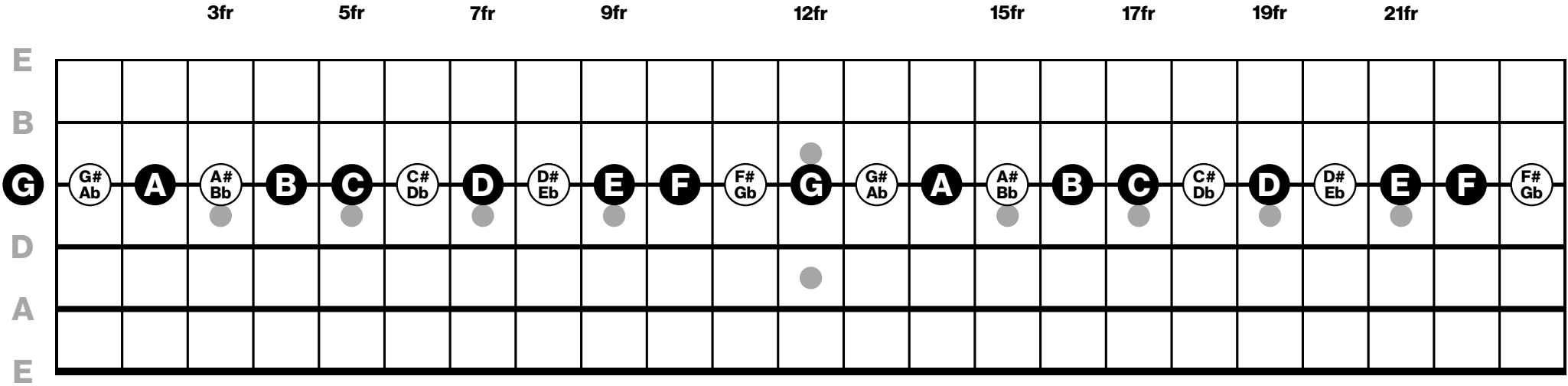
Notes on the 'A' String



Notes on the 'D' String



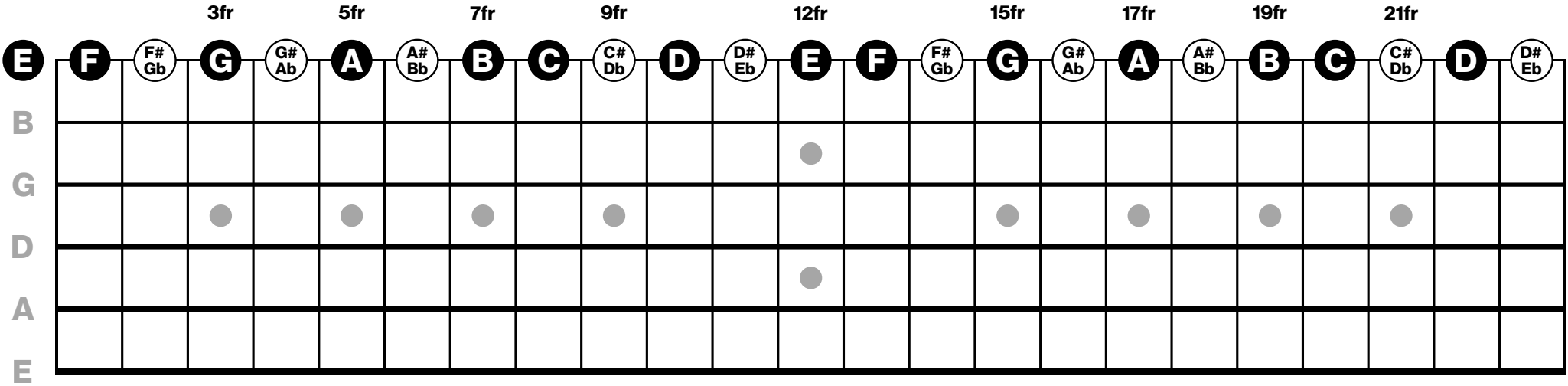
Notes on the 'G' String



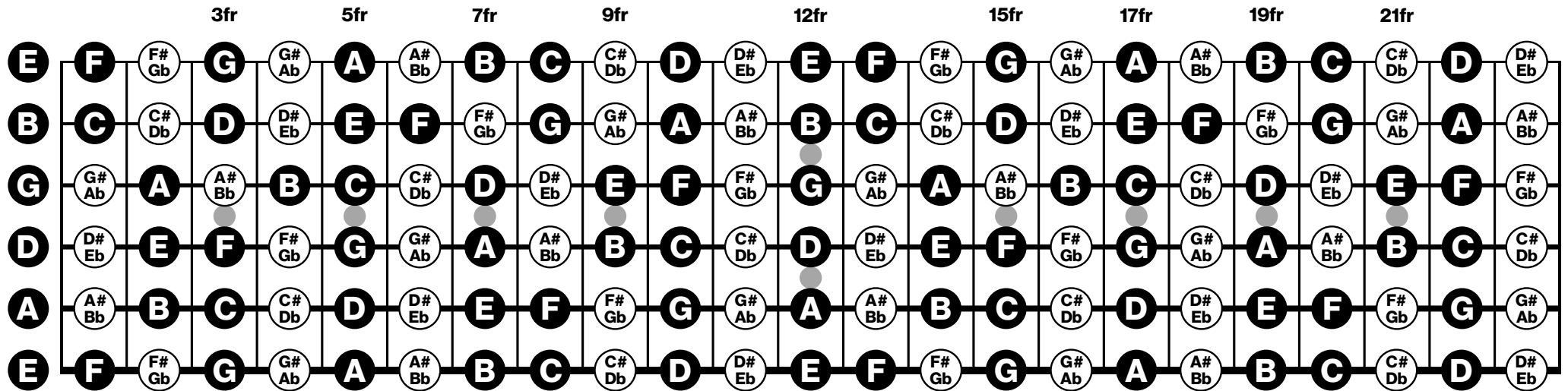
Notes on the 'B' String

[illegible]

Notes on the 'E' String (High)



Notes on the Fretboard



The Trick

You can use these octave shapes to find any note on the guitar.

Octave shape 1—Low E and A string

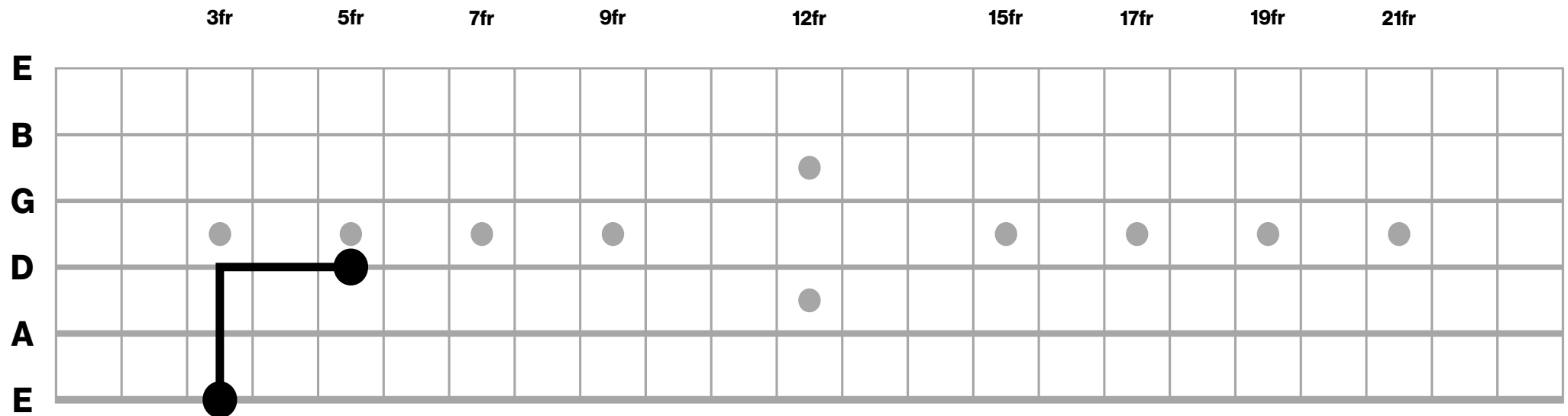
Octave shape 2—D and G string

Octave shape 3—B string (I didn't go over this in the video, but I should have!)

Whatever note you play on the dot, it'll be that same note on the other dot, just an octave higher or lower.

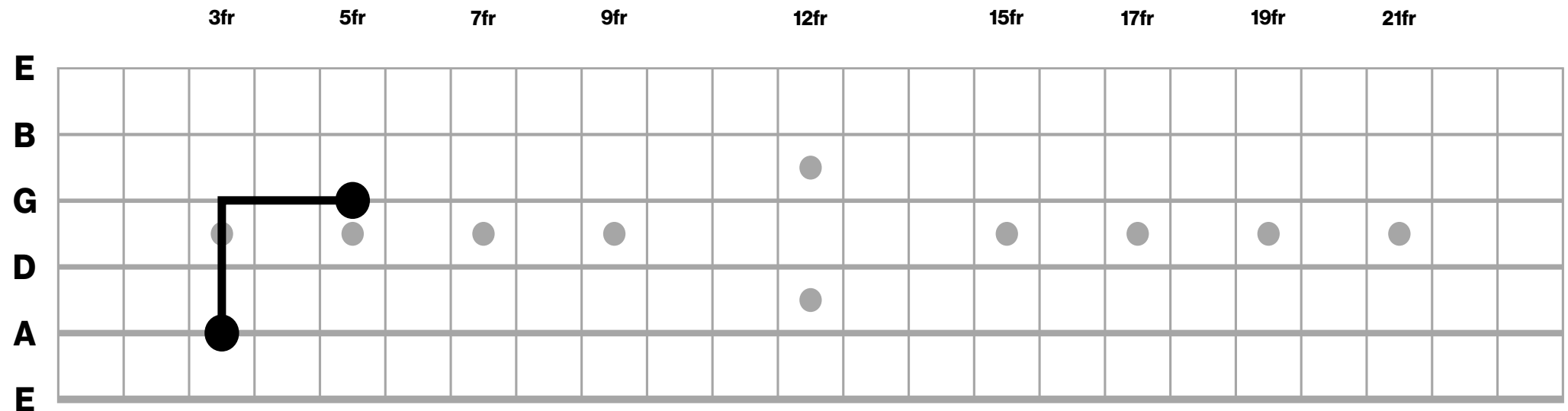
Octave Shape 1 (on the low E string)

Up two strings and up two frets.



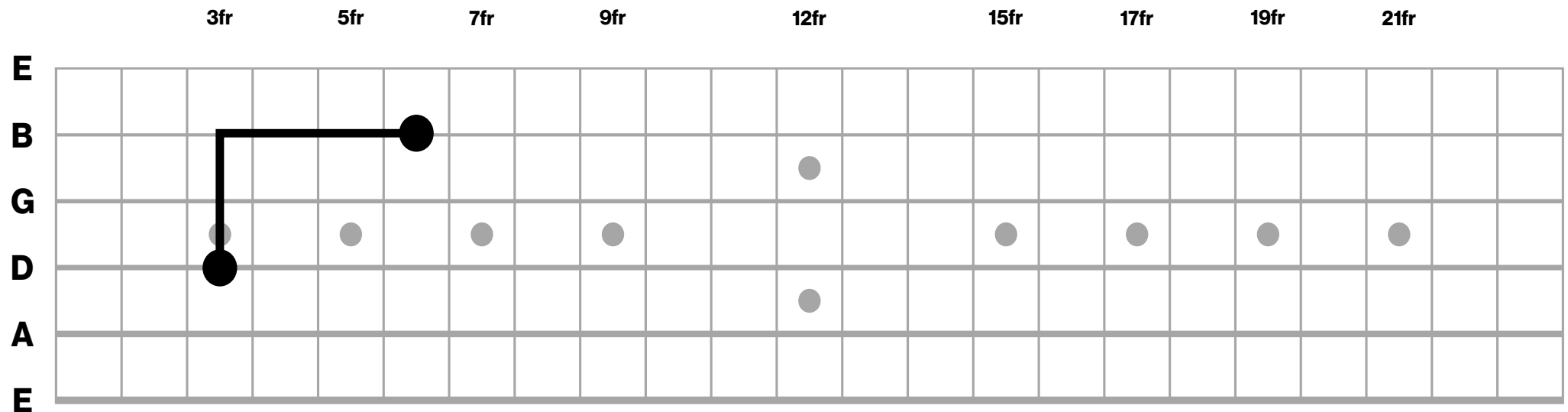
Octave Shape 1 (on the A string)

Up two strings and up two frets.



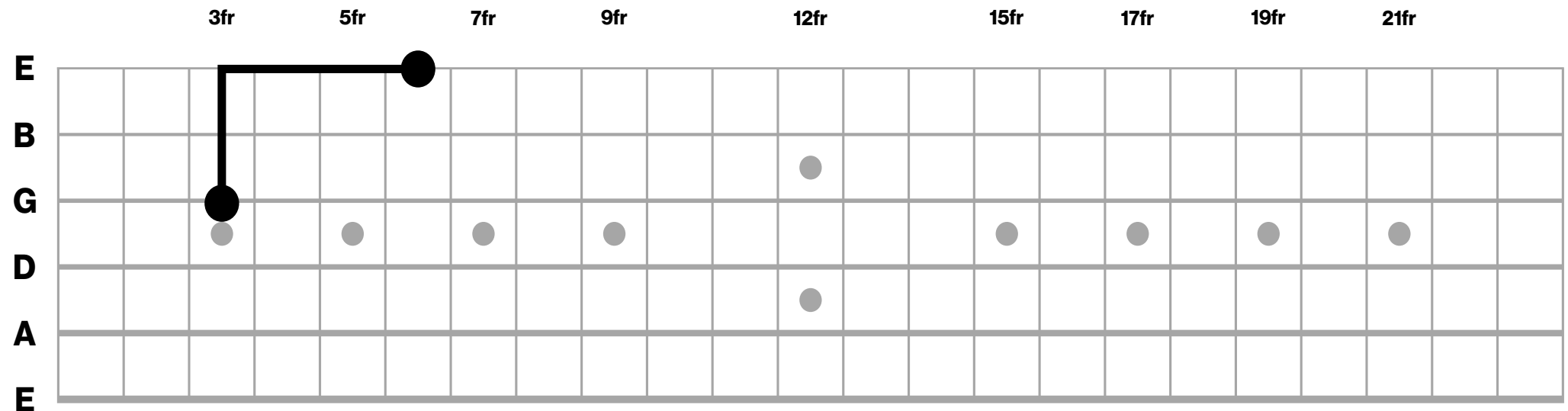
Octave Shape 2 (on the D string)

Up two strings and up three frets.



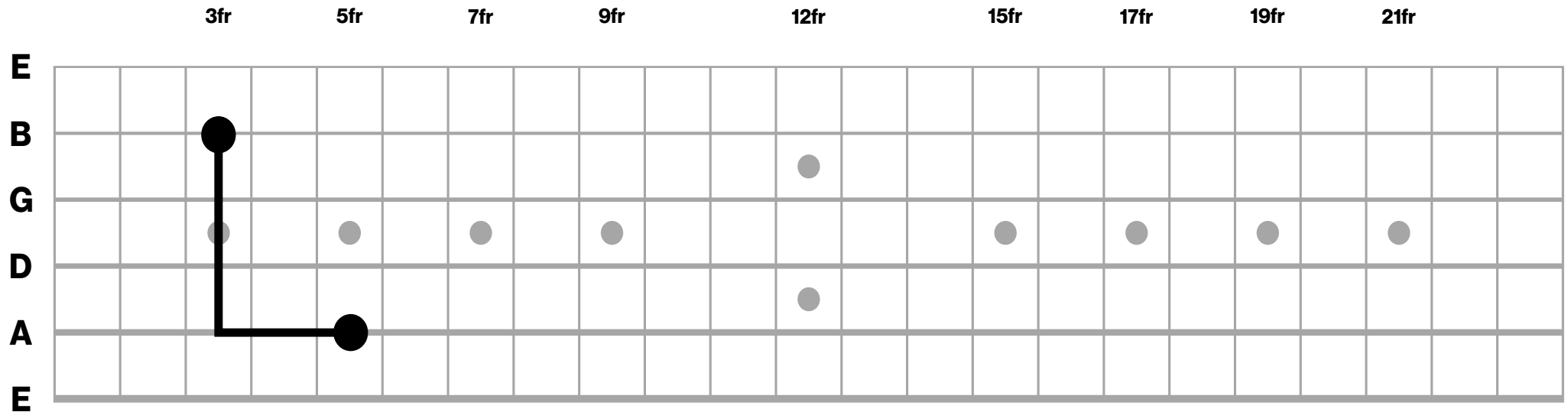
Octave Shape 2 (on the G string)

Up two strings and up three frets.



Octave Shape 3 (on the B string)

Down 3 strings (the A string) and up 2 frets.



The End

Remember to practice this stuff in small sections.

Don't move to the next part until you are super solid on the current part.

Thanks :)

I hope this helps.

— Trey